Tide pools of the Pacific coast

A tide pool is a shallow basin of seawater left among the rocks when the ocean pulls back at low tide. Sea stars, anemones and hermit crabs live there, and each one has to survive hours of sun, wind and changing salt. Barnacles seal their shells shut to keep from drying out, while anemones tuck in their tentacles and wait for the water to return.

Visitors should step on bare rock, never on living creatures, and put every animal back exactly where it was found.